

RELAY

Business Action Plan

Version 2.0 | June 13, 2026

The Battleground Blueprint for the Founder

Document Version: 2.0

1. Executive Summary

Metric | Status

Student Interviews | 300+ completed

Financial Status | Break-even

MVP | Live and operational

Target Audience | NYU students (~60,000)

Launch Window | August 2026 (back-to-school)

Mission

Current Status

2. Why the Idea Works

2.1 Validated Demand

2.2 Network Effects

2.3 Timing

AI tutoring surge | ChatGPT/Claude are great for answers, terrible for hands-on skills (guitar, lifting, public speaking)

Skill economy rising | LinkedIn, Coursera, bootcamps all pushing skills-based hiring over degrees

2.4 Founder-Market Fit

3. The 5 Risks (Addressed)

The Concern | The Reality

Students are broke and expect free | Private tutors cost \$40-80/hr. A \$14.99/mo plan is 1-2 UberEats deliveries.

Freemium kills paid conversion | Free tier limits to 2 credits + 2 listings. Students hit the paywall FAST.

Factor

Competitors are free (YouTube, Discord) | YouTube can't correct your guitar fingering. Discord can't tell you your squat

Verdict: You don't need everyone to pay. If 15% of 3,000 users convert to Starter (\$14.99) = \$6,750/mo. That's a business.

Why Relay avoids this trap:

Mitigation stack:

Right now: Vitamin. Students would go back to "ask a friend" or YouTube.

How to become a painkiller:

Risk #5: Competition

Competitor | Relay's Advantage

YouTube tutorials | Live, personalized feedback. Can't correct YOUR specific issue.

Discord study servers | Structured, time-boxed sessions with scheduling. No ghosting.

AI tutoring (ChatGPT, Claude, Khanmigo) | Great for academic Q&A. Useless for hands-on skills (gym, guitar, cooking, pub

Paid tutoring (Wyzant, Varsity Tutors) | 10x cheaper. \$14.99/mo vs \$40-80/hr.

Skillshare/Coursera | Pre-recorded, not live. No interaction. No peer accountability.

Moat: Live, peer-to-peer, .edu-verified, credit-based (not cash). The barter mechanic keeps prices at zero while creating genuine value.

4. Monetization Strategy

Pricing Tiers

Tier | Price | Credits/Month | Active Listings | Key Perks

Free | \$0 | 2 (signup bonus) | 2 | Browse, earn-by-teaching

Starter | \$14.99/mo | 5 monthly | 3 | Verified badge, priority matching

Pro | \$29.99/mo | Unlimited | Unlimited | Analytics, all perks

Annual Pro | \$249/yr (\$20.75/mo) | Unlimited | Unlimited | Save 31% vs monthly

Why These Prices Work

Credit Economy

Sign up (free) | +2 credits

Teach a 30-min session | +1 credit

Refer a friend | +1 credit (both sides)

Action

Starter plan renewal | +5 credits monthly
Pro plan | Unlimited sessions

5. Profit Math

Monthly Revenue Projections

User Base | Free Users | Starter (\$14.99) | Pro (\$29.99) | Monthly Revenue | Annual Run Rate

500 users | 400 | 75 (15%) | 25 (5%) | \$1,875 | \$22,500
1,000 users | 800 | 150 (15%) | 50 (5%) | \$3,750 | \$45,000
3,000 users | 2,400 | 450 (15%) | 150 (5%) | \$11,250 | \$135,000
5,000 users | 4,000 | 750 (15%) | 250 (5%) | \$18,750 | \$225,000

Costs

Server (Render/Railway) | \$50-100
Domain & email | \$15
Stripe fees (~3%) | ~\$200-500 at scale
Total overhead | ~\$300/mo

Net Profit

6. August Launch Checklist

7. Distribution Playbook

Campus Tactics (NYU)

Tactic | Effort | Impact | Timeline

Professor syllabus referral | LOW (5 emails) | HIGH | Week 1
Flyer Stern/Kimmel dorms | MED (afternoon) | MED-HIGH | Week 1
NYU Facebook/Reddit posts | LOW (30 min) | HIGH | Week 1
Tab at Kimmel Center | HIGH (day) | HIGH | Launch week
DM club presidents (50 clubs) | MED | VERY HIGH | Week 2
IG content (behind the build) | MED | COMPOUNDING | Ongoing

The Professor Referral Hack

One syllabus mention = 50-200 students. FREE.

IG Content Engine (7-Day Calendar)

- 1 | "Built a skill exchange. Here's what 300 students told me." | Founder story
- 2 | "I changed the pricing from \$5 to \$15 and this happened" | Transparency sells
- 3 | Demo video: sign up, find a skill, book a session | Product demo
- 4 | "Students are trading Python for guitar lessons" | Social proof
- 5 | Behind the scenes: code, late nights, mistakes | Relatability
- 6 | Student testimonial / review screenshot | Trust
- 7 | "Why I'm skipping the caf food to build this instead" | Personality

Club Partnerships

8. Week 1 Action Plan

Day	Task	Deliverable	Time
Mon	Survey current users: "What would you pay \$14.99/mo for?"	Google Form + share with 50+ users	1 hr
Tue	Add Stripe "donate" button to Relay	Test willingness to pay	2 hrs
Wed	Fix rating system (review details, public profiles)	Working reviews on profile pages	3 hrs
Thu	Update pricing in code, push to GitHub, deploy	New pricing live	1 hr
Fri	Post IG/FB: "I built a skill exchange. 300 users. Here's what I learned."	Content posted	1 hr
Sat	DM 10 club presidents, send professor emails	10 conversations started	1 hr
Sun	Review week 1 metrics: signups, credits used, sessions booked	Dashboard review	30 min

Success Metrics for Week 1

10. Risk Mitigation

Risk	Probability	Severity	Mitigation
Students won't pay	MEDIUM	HIGH	Freemium model + low starting price + survey validation before building
Quality drops at scale	HIGH	HIGH	Rating system P0 + no-show penalties + .edu verification
Competition copies	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Execute faster + build community (network effects are a moat)
Burnout	HIGH	HIGH	Keep scope small. One university. One vertical. One pricing lever.
Low repeat usage	MEDIUM	HIGH	Referral rewards, streak system, syllabus integration

Contingency Plans

11. Key Metrics Dashboard

North Star Metric

Input Metrics (What You Control)

- New signups/day | 5-10 | 20-50
- Skills listed | 50+ | 200+
- Sessions completed/week | 10+ | 100+
- Paying users | 1-5 | 50+
- Credits in circulation | 100+ | 500+

Output Metrics (What They Tell You)

- Repeat session rate | >40% | <20%
- Credit velocity (days to spend) | <14 days | >30 days
- Teacher retention (monthly) | >60% | <30%

12. Founder Operating Cadence

Weekly Schedule (20-30 hrs)

- Day | Focus | Hours
- Monday | Product (code, fix, ship) | 4-6
- Tuesday | Growth (outreach, content, partnerships) | 4-6
- Wednesday | Product | 4-6
- Thursday | Growth | 4-6
- Friday | Review week metrics + plan next week | 2-3
- Saturday | Chill / IG content | 1-2
- Sunday | Rest | 0

Monthly Review

Burn Rate

- Server | \$50-100
- Domain/email | \$15
- Stripe fees | 3% of revenue
- Your "salary" | \$0 until paying users cover it

Appendix A: Emergency Playbook

If a launch goes wrong (zero traction):

Your safety net: You're a NYU student with technical skills, an audience, and multiple income streams. Relay is one bet. Don't bet the farm.

Appendix B: Quick Reference

Action | Who | What

- Pricing change | main.py | Update FREE_CREDITS, pricing constants
- Stripe test | Add simple donation button | Use Stripe Checkout (no backend needed)
- Rating fix | review_session.html + main.py | Verify rating saves + shows on profile
- Professor email | Draft + send | 5 professors, personalized
- IG post | Your account | "I built a skill exchange at NYU"

"Your price was never the problem. Your confidence was. Triple it."